

Munir Ozturhan

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Research Interests

Psycholinguistics; Neurolinguistics; Language acquisition and processing

Education

University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS, USA Jan. 2021 – July 2026
Ph.D. in Linguistics

Dissertation project: *Temporal dynamics of argument-verb computations in sentence processing in Turkish: Evidence from Event-related potential*

Master's research project: *Sensitivity to animacy information in processing subject-verb agreement dependencies in Turkish*

Boğaziçi University, Istanbul, Turkey Sept. 2015 – Aug. 2018
M.A. in English Language Education

Master's thesis: *Processing reflexives in the L2: Evidence from eye-tracking*

Boğaziçi University, Istanbul, Turkey Sept. 2010 – June 2015
B.A. in Foreign Language Education; Minor in Linguistics

Universitat de València, Valencia, Spain Jan. 2014 – June 2014
Erasmus study period, Department of Primary Education

Publications

Journal Articles

Ozturhan, M., & Minai, U (under review). Examining children's sensitivity to morphologically-marked focus in the comprehension of question sentences: Evidence from quantifier comprehension in child Turkish. *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*.

Ozturhan, M., Fiorentino, R., & Gabriele, A. (under review). Examining the factors that impact feature reassembly: Subject-verb agreement in L1 and L2 Turkish. *Linguistic Approaches to Bilingualism*. [Stimuli](#), [Data](#), [R Scripts](#), [Results tables](#)

Bayyurt, Y., İnal, D., **Ozturhan, M.**, & Bektaş, S. (2021). Multilingualism in the linguistic landscape of Istanbul. *World Englishes*, 40(2), 280–289. <https://doi.org/10.1111/weng.12514>.

Other Publications

Ozturhan, M., & Chan, M. (2024). Exploring effective strategies for teaching English past tense in instructed settings. *OASIS Summary* of Chan, M. (2019) in *System*. <https://oasis-database.org>.

Conference Presentations

Gabriele, A., Alemán-Bañón, J., **Ozturhan, M.**, Swaim, B., Collins, A., Mancini, S., Carreiras, M., Hoffman, L., & Fiorentino, R. (June 2026). Examining the role of verbal abilities and task effects in the processing of referential ambiguity in the L1 and L2: Evidence from ERPs. *Neurolinguistics in Sweden, NLS 2026*. University of Stockholm, Sweden. [Oral presentation]

Ozturhan, M., Gabriele, A., & Fiorentino, R. (March 2026). Temporal dynamics of argument-verb computations in sentence processing: New evidence from Turkish. *39th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*. Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, USA. [Poster presentation]

- Minai, U., Nobuki, A., **Ozturhan, M.**, Wang, X., Williams Osbuohien, L., & Monteleone, A. (May 2025). Probing discourse cues facilitating children's quantifier comprehension: The effectiveness of the Question Under Discussion disambiguation. *The Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD) Biennial Meeting*. Minneapolis, Minnesota, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Gabriele, A., **Ozturhan, M.**, Alemán-Bañón, J., Collins, A., Swaim, B., Yang, X., Carreiras, M., Mancini, S., Hoffman, L., & Fiorentino, R. (March 2025). Integrating discourse information in a second language: Evidence from event-related potentials. *Cognitive Neuroscience Society 2025 Annual Meeting*. Boston, Massachusetts, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Politzer-Ahles, S., **Ozturhan, M.**, Church, L., & Wang, X. (March 2025). Long-lag morphological priming depends on form overlap. *38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing*. University of Maryland, College Park, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Ozturhan, M.**, & Minai, U. (November 2024). Pragmatic factors facilitating children's understanding of universal quantification: Evidence from child Turkish. *BUCLD 49: 2024 Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Boston University, Massachusetts, USA. [Oral presentation]
- Politzer-Ahles, S., **Ozturhan, M.**, Wang, X., & Church, L. (July 2024). Long-lag morphological priming depends on form overlap. *The Highlights in the Language Sciences Conference*. Radboud University, Nijmegen, Netherlands. [Poster presentation]
- Fiorentino, R., **Ozturhan, M.**, Collins, A., Yang, X., Swaim, B., Carreiras, M., Mancini, S., Hoffman, L., & Gabriele, A. (May 2024). Extending the English LexTALE to assess vocabulary knowledge in native speakers and advanced L2 learners. *37th Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference*. University of Michigan, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Ozturhan, M.**, Gabriele, A., & Fiorentino, R. (May 2024). The role of animacy in subject-verb agreement in L2 Turkish: Examining Feature Reassembly. *Generative Approaches to Second Language Acquisition (GASLA) 17*. University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Illinois, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Ozturhan, M.**, Gabriele, A., & Fiorentino, R. (November 2023). Sensitivity to animacy information in 3rd person plural agreement in L2 Turkish. *BUCLD 48: 2023 Boston University Conference on Language Development*. Boston University, Massachusetts, USA. [Oral presentation]
- Gabriele, A., Alemán-Bañón, J., Yang, X., Collins, A., **Ozturhan, M.**, Mancini, S., Carreiras, M., & Fiorentino, R. (March 2023). Referential ambiguity in native and non-native processing: Evidence from ERPs. *36th Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference*. University of Pittsburgh, USA. [Poster presentation]
- Ozturhan, M.**, & Deniz, N. D. (March 2022). Morphological, syntactic and semantic information in processing reflexives in Turkish: Cascaded cue integration? *35th Annual Human Sentence Processing Conference*. University of California at Santa Cruz, California, USA. [Poster presentation, online]
- Ozturhan, M.**, & Haznedar, B. (October 2021). Language support program for migrant children: Evidence from Syrian bilingual children in a Turkish context. *BMRS21 – Bilingualism Matters Research Symposium 2021*. [Oral presentation, online]
- Ozturhan, M.**, Tuzcu, A., & Yalcin, S. (June 2021). The role of proficiency and target structure in L2 learners' grammatical sensitivity: Evidence from eye-tracking. *The 15th Language at the University of Essex Postgraduate Conference (LangUE)*. University of Essex, Essex, England. [Poster presentation, online]
- Ozturhan, M.**, & Deniz, N. D. (June 2021). The use of structural and non-structural information in L2 processing of reflexives. *3rd International Symposium on Bilingual and L2 Processing in Adults and Children (ISBPAC)*. Nijmegen, Netherlands. [Poster presentation, online]
- Tuzcu, A., **Ozturhan, M.**, & Yalcin, S. (September 2019). What can eye-tracking data tell about structure difficulty and GJT performance? *The 2019 Second Language Research Forum (SLRF)*. Michigan State University, Michigan, USA. [Oral presentation]

Ozturhan, M., & Deniz, N. D. (August 2019). Processing of English reflexives by Turkish speakers: An eye-tracking study. *29th EuroSLA Conference*. Lund University, Lund, Sweden. [Oral presentation]

Ozturhan, M., & Deniz, N. D. (March 2019). Timing of structural and non-structural information in processing of reflexives in the L2. *32nd Annual CUNY Sentence Processing Conference*. University of Colorado Boulder, Colorado, USA. [Poster presentation]

Invited Talks

Ozturhan, M. (February 2026). Temporal dynamics of argument-verb computations in Turkish sentence processing. *Lightning Talks for Colloquy Series*. University of Kansas.

Ozturhan, M. (February 2025). Linguistic and pragmatic factors affecting the comprehension of universal quantifiers in child Turkish. *Child Language Proseminar Series*. University of Kansas.

Ozturhan, M. (September 2023). The effects of animacy information on the processing of 3rd person plural agreement in L2 Turkish. *Child Language Proseminar Series*. University of Kansas.

Ozturhan, M., Bektaş, S., Bayyurt, Y., & İnal, D. (September 2019). Emergent multilingualism in the ENRICHed linguistic landscapes of major metropolitan cities in Turkey. *Boğaziçi University Sociolinguistics Research Group Lecture Series*. Boğaziçi University, Istanbul.

Teaching Experience

University of Kansas

Instructor of Record

LING 110: Language and Mind (online)

Spring 2026; Spring 2025; Summer 2022

LING/ANTH 106: Introductory Linguistics (online)

Fall 2025; Summer 2023

Teaching Assistant

LING 110: Language and Mind (in-person)

Fall 2024; Spring 2024; Spring 2022; Fall 2021; Spring 2021

Boğaziçi University

Teaching Assistant

FLED 315: Sociolinguistics and English Language Education

Spring 2020; Fall 2019; Spring 2019

BOUN 101: Tips for Academic Writing

Summer 2020; Summer 2019

Intermediate Turkish

June – August 2015

Grader

FLED 211: English Language Awareness

Fall 2017 – Fall 2020

Research Experience

Research Assistant

Aug. 2022 – Present

Examining native language variability and its effects on second language processing: An ERP investigation of referential dependencies

PIs: Alison Gabriele & Robert Fiorentino [NSF #1747143](#)

- Coordinated EEG and behavioral data collection from 180 participants across labs in the United States and Spain; standardized procedures across sites.
- Built MATLAB/EEGLAB preprocessing workflows for continuous EEG, artifact rejection, segmentation, and analysis-ready datasets.
- Integrated EEG data with a 12-task battery spanning vocabulary, proficiency, working memory, executive function, language comprehension, and behavioral measures.
- Trained and supervised undergraduate and graduate research assistants on study setup, human-subjects ethics, EEG data collection, and data analysis workflows.

Research Assistant Mar. 2023 – Present
Semantics and pragmatics in children's meaning comprehension
 PI: Utako Minai

- Designed and ran behavioral experiments with monolingual English-speaking preschool children in kindergarten and lab settings.
- Managed in-person and online data collection, participant tracking, and data workflows.
- Supervised undergraduate and graduate research assistants supporting data collection and project logistics.

Research Assistant Dec. 2023 – Present
Long-term morphological priming without form similarity
 PI: Stephen Politzer-Ahles

- Recruited and scheduled participants and ran priming experiments.

Research Assistant 2022 – July 2023
Processing negative polarity items in L1 and L2 Turkish
 PI: Nazik Dinçtopal Deniz, Boğaziçi University; funded by TÜBİTAK #221K063

- Developed stimuli for eye-tracking experiments on negative polarity item processing in Turkish.

Honors and Scholarships

Research Excellence Initiative Award , University of Kansas, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences; research incentive for applying to external funding for research (\$1,000)	Apr. 2025
2025 Summer Research Scholarship , University of Kansas, Office of Graduate Studies; scholarship supporting graduate students in advancing summer research (\$6,000)	Mar. 2025
Paula Menyuk Award , Boston University Conference on Language Development; travel award for first authors with top-rated abstracts at BUCLD 49 (\$385)	Nov. 2024
KU Linguistics Graduate Travel Award , Department of Linguistics, University of Kansas; travel support for BUCLD 49 (\$500)	Nov. 2024
University of Kansas Graduate Student Travel Fund ; travel support for BUCLD 49 (\$750)	Sept. 2024
GASLA-17 Travel Award , Generative Approaches to Second Language Acquisition 17; travel award (\$250)	May 2024
Paula Menyuk Award , Boston University Conference on Language Development; travel award for first authors with top-rated abstracts at BUCLD 48 (\$385)	Nov. 2023
KU Linguistics Graduate Travel Award , Department of Linguistics, University of Kansas; travel support for BUCLD 48 (\$500)	Nov. 2023
M.A. Completion Linguistics Achievement Award , Department of Linguistics, University of Kansas; merit-based scholarship for completion of the M.A. thesis (\$2,000)	Dec. 2022
Frances Ingemann Graduate Student Research Scholarship , Department of Linguistics, University of Kansas; research support for M.A. project (\$500)	Oct. 2022
2224-A Travel Fellowship , The Scientific and Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK); travel support for the 29th EuroSLA Conference (\$700)	Nov. 2019
Student Stipend for SLRF19 Conference , Michigan State University; travel support for the 2019 Second Language Research Forum (\$1,000)	Sept. 2019
2210-A National Scholarship for M.A. Students , The Scientific and Research Council of Turkey (TÜBİTAK)	2016–2017
Prof. Dr. Cem Alptekin Award , Foreign Language Education Department, Boğaziçi University; awarded to students with exemplary academic studies and activities	June 2015

Manuscript Reviewing

Applied Psycholinguistics	Co-reviewer, 2024
Language and Linguistics Compass	Co-reviewer, 2024
Second Language Research	Co-reviewer, 2024; 2025
Glossa Psycholinguistics	Co-reviewer, 2023
Studies in Second Language Acquisition	Co-reviewer, 2023

Professional Service

Treasurer, Linguistics Graduate Student Association, University of Kansas	Aug. 2025 – May 2026
Secretary, Linguistics Graduate Student Association, University of Kansas	Aug. 2024 – May 2025
Vice President, Linguistics Graduate Student Association, University of Kansas	Aug. 2023 – May 2024
Member, Linguistics Colloquy Committee, University of Kansas	Fall 2021 – Spring 2024
Student representative in faculty meetings, Department of Linguistics, University of Kansas	Fall 2022; Spring 2024
Member, Diversity, Equity, Inclusion & Belonging Committee, University of Kansas	Aug. 2022 – Mar. 2023

Skills and Languages

Programming & statistics	R (mixed-effects models, Bayesian analysis, OLS regression, ANOVA, visualization); Python (data analysis, visualization, machine-learning methods including random forests); MATLAB; $\LaTeX$
Brain-imaging	EEGLAB (preprocessing pipelines, artifact rejection, segmentation); Paradigm & PsychoPy (EEG study setup)
Eye-tracking	EyeLink Experiment Builder
Acoustic analysis	Praat
Experimental & data collection	PCIBex; Qualtrics; Prolific
Open science	OSF (sharing of stimuli, materials, and analysis scripts)
Languages	Turkish (native language), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (beginner)

Contact Information for Letters of Recommendation

Dr. Alison Gabriele	gabriele@ku.edu
Dr. Robert Fiorentino	fiorentino@ku.edu
Dr. Utako Minai	minai@ku.edu